

Contents

1	Accents	3
1.1	Accent Aigu (é)	3
1.2	Accent Grave (è)	3
1.3	Accent Circonflexe (ê)	3
1.4	Tréma (ë)	3
1.5	Cédille (ç)	4
2	Silent Letters	5
3	Links	7
3.1	Mandatory Links	7
3.2	Forbidden Links	7
4	Sound	9
4.1	é [e]	9
4.2	è [ɛ]	9
4.3	Nasal Vowel ON	11
4.4	AN [ɑ̃]	11
4.5	IN [ɛ̃]	11
4.6	UN [œ]	11
4.7	IEN [jɛ̃]	12
4.8	OIN [wɛ̃]	12

Chapter 1

Accents

1.1 Accent Aigu (é)

- [e]: *été*
- [je]: *épée*

1.2 Accent Grave (è)

1. à, ù: pronunciation doesn't change, purpose is to differentiate words
2. è:
 - [ɛ]: *père*

1.3 Accent Circonflexe (ê)

1. ê, same pronunciation as è
2. â, longer and softer compare to a, [a]: *pâte*. In real life, word with â takes longer.
3. î, longer yi, [i]: *île*
4. ô, soft ò, [o]: *hôtel*
5. û, longer and softer u, [y]: *jeûne*

1.4 Tréma (ë)

Vowel has to be pronounced separately from the previous one, same sound as è.

- [ɛ]: *Noël*

1.5 Cédille (ç)

Usually followed by a, o, u, never an e or i.

- [s]: *garçon*

Chapter 2

Silent Letters

1. E preceded by a vowel

- IE = [i]: *pied*
- AIE = AI(È), *monnaie*: [mɔ̃nɛ] (change)
- UE, *avenue*: [avøny]
- OIE (wà), *poisson*: [pwasɔ]
- OUE (wù wà), *boue*: [bu] (bù wà) (mud)
- EUE (wù_è), open as it is the last sound. *vœu*: [vΛ] (wish)

2. E preceded by a consonant

- (a) B, C, D, G, N, P, R, S, T. Do not pronounce the E, it activates the consonant before.

3. E in the middle of the word

- No rule, the following are words where e isn't pronounced:

un paiement [pajmã] (payment)
un remerie [rəmeri] (thanks)
une proneade [prɔ̃nad] (walk)

- E is pronounced in articles and small words (2-3 letters).

4. Last consonant of the word

- B, a few words: *plomb* [plɔ̃] (lead)
- C: *banc* [bã] (bench)
- D: *fond* [fɔ̃] (bottom)
- F: un *œuf* [Λf] (egg)
- G: le poing [pwã] (fist), except for english words.

- L: *outil* [uti] (tool)
- P: *coup* [ku] (hit)
- S, how words are spelled in singular: *fils* [fis] (son)
- T: *l'art* [lar] (art)
- X: only for just how the word is spelled, *paix* [pɛ] (peace)
- Z: *le nez* [ləne] (nose)

5. Plural of words

- S: not pronounced: *les chats* [leʃa] (cats)
- X: not pronounced.

6. Plural of verbs

- -ENT: *il chante, ils chantent* [il ʃāt] (sing)
- *Irregular verb: *elle dort* [ɛl dɔr], *elles dorment* [il dɔrm] (sleep)

7. The letters H, U, M

- H
 - (a) Do not pronounce if it's in the beginning of the word: *hôtel* [ɔtel] (hotel)
 - (b) Acts as separation in the middle of the word: *cohérent* [ko.erɑ̃] (coherent)
- U
 - (a) When u is after q, do not pronounce u: *qui* [ki] (who)
 - (b) When u is after g, do not pronounce u: *guerre* [gɛr] (war)
- M
 - (a) L'automne [lotɔm] (autumn), condamner [kɔ.damne] (condemn)

Chapter 3

Links

3.1 Mandatory Links

1. Articles and nouns: *les amis* [le.zami] (friends)
2. Numbers and nouns: *vingt ans* [vãz] (twenty years)
3. Adjective and nouns: *Bon anniversaire* [bɔnanivɛʁsɛʁ] (happy birthday)
4. Pronouns and pronouns: *Nous y allons* [nu.zi.alɔ̃] (we are going)
5. Pronouns and verbs: *Nous étuions* [nu.zetudjɔ̃] (we were studying)
6. After short adverbs: *Bien arrivé* [bjãnari.ve] (well arrived)
7. *Quand est-ce que* [kãtestkə] (when)

3.2 Forbidden Links

1. Before H aspiré (act as consonant), non-silent: *un haricot* [ynarikɔ] (bean)
2. Number before 11
3. Before *oui*
4. After a name
5. After singular nouns
6. After *et*, *comment*, *combien*, *toujours*, *quand* with the exception of *quand est-ce que*

Chapter 4

Sound

4.1 é [e]

1. é, found anywhere in the word or end of passé composé: *été* [ete] (summer)
2. AI
 - future form of verbs with *Je*: *j'irai* [ʒirɛ] (I will go)
 - some specific words: *aimer* [ɛme] (to like)
3. ER
 - At the end of nouns: *hiver* [ivɛ] (winter)
 - Infinitive form of -ER verbs: *manger* [mãʒe] (to eat)
4. EZ
 - At the end of some words: *assez* [asɛ] (enough)
 - Present form of *vous*: *vous mangez* [vu mãʒe] (you eat)
5. ED: *un pied* [œpjɛ] (foot)
6. E
 - At the beginning of words: *Effacer* [ɛfase] (to erase)
 - The word *et* by itself is always pronounced [e] (and), different if it's part of a word.

4.2 è [ɛ]

1. È, anywhere in the word
2. Ê, anywhere in the word

3. *Ë*: *Noël* [nɔɛl] (Christmas)

4. *E*

- Before the last audible letters: *la mer* [lamɛ] (the sea)
- Before two consonants (or more): *celle* [sɛl] (that)

5. *AIS*

- At the end of some words: *mais* [mɛ] (but)
- Imparfait form with *Je, tu*: *je mangeais* [ʒə mɑ̃ʒɛ] (I was eating)
- Conditionel form with *Je, tu*: *je mangerais* [ʒə mɑ̃grɛ] (I would eat)
* If no -s, it means *will*, not *would*

6. *AIT*

- at the end of some words: *du lait* [dylɛ] (milk)
- Imparfait form with *Il, elle, on*: *il mangeait* [il mɑ̃ʒɛ] (he was eating)
- Conditionel form with *Il, elle, on*: *il mangerait* [il mɑ̃grɛ] (he would eat)

7. *AIENT*, do not pronounce the *ENT*

- Imparfait form with *Ils, elles*: *ils mangeaient* [il mɑ̃ʒɛ] (they were eating)
- COnditionel form with *Ils, elles*: *ils mangeraient* [il mɑ̃grɛ] (they would eat)

8. *EI*, anywhere in the word: *un reine* [œrɛn] (queen)

9. *ET*, at the end of words: *un livrat* [livrɛ] (booklet)

10. *AI*

- inside the word: *la laine* [lɛ lɛn] (wool)
- at the end of some words, not related to conjugation: *un balai* [bale] (broom)
- Varies depends on area, might not be light.

11. *ES / EST*

- Present form of *être* with *tu, il, elle, on*: *tu es* [ty ɛ] (you are)
- *ES*, in small words: *des, les, ces, mes, tes, ses*

12. *EY*: *unu poney* [ynə pɔnɛ] (pony)

13. *ECT*, end of words: *un suspect* [syspɛ] (suspect)

4.3 Nasal Vowel ON

1. ON: *Bonbon* [bõbõ] (candy)
2. OM, before B or P: *Compter* [kõtẽ] (to count)

4.4 AN [ã]

1. AN: *Dans* [dã] (in)
2. AM, before B or P: *Champ* [ʃã] (field)
3. EN: *lent* [lã] (slow)
4. EM, before B or P: *le temps* [lẽ tã] (the weather)
5. * extra: AON, found in three words:
 - (a) *un faon* [fã] (fawn)
 - (b) *un town* [tã] (town)
 - (c) *un paon* [pã] (peacock)

4.5 IN [ẽ]

Higher compare to [œ]

1. IN: *fin* [fẽ] (end)
2. IM, before B or P: *simple* [sẽpl] (simple)
3. AIN: *pain* [pẽ] (bread)
4. EIN: *une peinture* [yn pẽtyr] (a painting)
5. AIM: *la faim* [la fẽ] (hunger)
6. YN: *un lynx* [lẽks] (lynx)
7. YM, before B or P: *un symbole* [sẽbɔl] (symbol)
8. EN, irregular but common word: *un examen* [ɛgzamẽ] (exam)

4.6 UN œ

1. In northern France, same as [ẽ] (ā èng)
2. In southern France, lower sound (èng)

4.7 IEN [jɛ̃]

Rolling I, like third accent: *un bien* [jɛ̃] (good)

4.8 OIN [wɛ̃]

Moins [mwɛ̃] (less)